

Privacy Policy

CoolPeople — how we collect, use, protect, and share your information

DRAFT FOR LEGAL REVIEW — NOT YET EFFECTIVE. This is a platform-tailored draft, **not legal advice**, and has not been reviewed by counsel. CoolPeople handles sensitive categories (political activity, precise location used transiently, data about minors) and is subject to GDPR, CCPA/CPRA, TCPA, COPPA, and federal election and reporting law. **Have a qualified privacy attorney review and approve this before publication.** Bracketed red items are placeholders to complete.

Controller: [Legal Entity Name, Inc.] (“CoolPeople,” “we,” “us”) • **Version:** Draft v0.1 • **Draft date:** June 17, 2026
• **Effective date:** [on publication] • **Contact / DPO:** [privacy@coolpeople.example]

This Privacy Policy explains what information CoolPeople collects, how we use and share it, and the choices and rights you have. It is incorporated into our Terms of Service. Capitalized terms not defined here have the meaning given in the Terms.

1. A Note on Money & Political Contributions

Understanding our money model helps explain our data practices: **CoolPeople never touches, holds, or processes campaign contributions.** Campaign “pledges” are non-binding promises and never transact on the Service. The only real money we handle is (a) optional **tips to the platform**, (b) a **flat fee paid by a debate poster/sponsor**, and (c) a small **per-transaction markup on debate-side transactions**. Card payments are handled by our payment processor; we do not store full card numbers. Because we are not a contribution processor, we do not collect or retain donation/contribution payment data.

2. Information We Collect

Category	Examples
Account & profile	Username, name, email, phone, date of birth (for age verification/bands), password (stored only as a salted hash), profile details.
Address (transient)	A street address you provide is used only momentarily to resolve your civic jurisdictions, then discarded — see Section 3.
Jurisdiction links	The derived districts/jurisdictions you belong to (e.g., state, county, council district), stored to power relevant offices, deadlines, and notifications.
Attestations & consents	Append-only records of factual attestations (e.g., citizenship/LPR status, age, own-funds) and consents, with the date, time, method, IP address, and user-agent captured for legal recordkeeping.

Candidacy / WouldBe data	Campaign details, committee/treasurer information you provide, filing receipts, processor links, plans, and pledges you make or receive.
Content	Posts, videos, comments, debate entries, votes, endorsements, and (for livestreamed debates) recordings you consent to.
Payment-related	For tips, sponsor fees, entries, and payouts: limited transaction metadata and, for payouts, tax identifiers (e.g., for 1099/1042-S). Card data is held by the processor, not us.
Device & usage	IP address, browser/device identifiers, log and analytics data, and interactions with the Service.

3. How We Handle Your Address (Transient-Only)

When you provide a street address, we send it to a geocoding provider to determine your civic jurisdictions. We retain only the **derived jurisdiction links** (and, where applicable, a coarse coordinate/centroid used for boundary resolution). **We do not persist your street address.** This minimizes sensitive location data while still letting us show you relevant offices, deadlines, and notifications.

4. How We Use Information

- Provide, operate, secure, and improve the Service and its features (WouldBe campaigns, pledges, debates, posts).
- Verify eligibility and age; record attestations and consents for legal compliance.
- Resolve jurisdictions to match you with relevant offices, deadlines, candidates, and notifications.
- Process the limited payments described in Section 1 and handle tax/reporting obligations for payouts.
- Send communications you have consented to, and operate the candidate-notification system under pre-established, uniformly applied objective criteria (see Section 6).
- Moderate content, enforce our Terms, prevent fraud and abuse, and comply with law and lawful requests.

5. Legal Bases (GDPR/UK GDPR, where applicable)

We process personal data on the bases of: **contract** (to provide the Service you request); **consent** (e.g., certain communications, optional data uses, and processing of special-category political-opinion data you choose to share); **legal obligation** (recordkeeping, tax, election and child-safety law); and **legitimate interests** (security, fraud prevention, and improving the Service), balanced against your rights. You may withdraw consent at any time.

6. Political Activity & the Candidate Notifier

- Information about your political activity (e.g., pledges, candidacy) is treated as sensitive. **We do not sell individual political data** (see Section 9).
- Where we notify users about relevant WouldBe campaigns, we apply **pre-established objective criteria, uniformly** (consistent with applicable election-law guidance such as 11 CFR 110.13), personalized only on preferences you have stated, and we log the objective inputs and the criteria version for each send.
- You control whether you receive these messages and on which channel, and can opt out at any time.

7. Communications & Consent (TCPA)

We send transactional and, where you opt in, promotional or notification messages by in-app, email, push, and/or SMS. We capture your consent with technical metadata. **You can withdraw consent or unsubscribe at any time** (e.g., reply STOP to SMS, use the unsubscribe link, or adjust settings). Withdrawing consent is recorded as a new record; we do not delete the prior consent history.

8. How We Share Information

We do not sell individual political data. We share information only as follows:

- **Service providers / processors** acting on our behalf under contract — for example: payment processing ([Stripe]), media storage/delivery ([Cloudflare R2 / Stream]), geocoding ([geocodio]), analytics ([PostHog]), messaging, and livestreaming ([Twitch]).
- **Public-by-design content** — your public profile, WouldBe pages, posts, debate entries, and similar content are visible to others as part of how the Service works.
- **Legal & safety** — to comply with law, lawful requests, or to protect rights and safety; including mandatory reporting of child sexual abuse material to the National Center for Missing & Exploited Children (NCMEC) and law enforcement as required by 18 U.S.C. § 2258A.
- **Business transfers** — in connection with a merger, acquisition, or asset sale, subject to this Policy.

9. “Sale” / “Sharing” of Personal Information (CCPA/CPRA)

We do **not** sell or share individual political data. To the extent any data practice is deemed a “sale” or “sharing” under California law, it is **opt-in only** and offered only to eligible users; pre-existing users are not enrolled. You may opt out (or decline to opt in) at any time, and we honor recognized opt-out preference signals where required. We do not knowingly sell or share the personal information of users we know to be under 16 without the required opt-in.

10. Data Retention

We keep personal data only as long as needed for the purposes described here or as required by law (including election, tax, and safety recordkeeping). Append-only records (attestations, consents, certain audit and moderation logs) are retained for their legal recordkeeping purpose even after related data changes. We operate retention policies that purge categories of data on defined schedules, and certain safety materials (e.g., CSAM-related preservation) are retained for legally mandated periods.

11. Your Privacy Rights (GDPR & CCPA/CPRA)

- Depending on your location, you may have rights to **access, correct, delete, port, restrict, or object** to processing of your personal data, and to **not be discriminated against** for exercising them.
- You can submit a data-subject request in-product or at [\[privacy@coolpeople.example\]](mailto:privacy@coolpeople.example). We verify identity before fulfilling requests and respond within the timeframes required by law (generally within **30 days**, extendable as permitted). Verified export requests produce a downloadable copy via a time-limited secure link, excluding credentials.
- You may appoint an authorized agent where the law permits, and you may appeal a denial as required by applicable law.

12. Children's Privacy

General accounts and all money/pledge features require users to be 18+. Certain debate features may be available to minors aged [\[13-17\]](#) only with verified parental/guardian consent and with feature restrictions and age-band controls applied. We do not knowingly collect personal information from children under 13 (or the applicable minimum age) without required consent; if we learn we have, we delete it. Parents/guardians may contact us to review, correct, or delete a minor's information.

13. Security

We use administrative, technical, and organizational safeguards appropriate to the data, including hashed passwords, encryption of sensitive tokens at rest, access controls, and **logging of staff access to personal information (PII access logs)**. No system is perfectly secure; we cannot guarantee absolute security.

14. International Data Transfers

We may process and store information in the United States and other countries. Where required, we use appropriate transfer mechanisms (e.g., Standard Contractual Clauses) for transfers of personal data out of the EEA/UK/Switzerland.

15. Cookies & Analytics

We and our analytics providers use cookies and similar technologies to operate the Service, remember preferences, and understand usage. You can control cookies through your browser and, where offered, in-product settings. [\[Insert cookie-banner/consent details for your analytics configuration.\]](#)

16. Changes to This Policy

We may update this Policy. Material changes will be indicated by a new version and effective date and, where appropriate, additional notice. Prior versions are retained for recordkeeping.

17. Contact Us

Privacy questions or requests: [\[privacy@coolpeople.example\]](mailto:privacy@coolpeople.example) • [\[mailing address\]](#) • EU/UK representative (if applicable): [\[name/address\]](#).

Acknowledgment

By accepting our Terms of Service and using CoolPeople, I acknowledge that I have read and understood this Privacy Policy, including how my address is used transiently and discarded, how my political activity and attestations are handled, and my rights and choices regarding my information.

Printed name (for offline/wet-ink use, if applicable)

Signature & date

Electronic acknowledgment recorded by the platform: user ID, policy version, timestamp, IP address, and user-agent.